

Terms & Conditions of Service

Scope of Service

The Origin Hunter provides genealogical and family history research based on information supplied by the client, available historical records and the research sources reasonably accessible to the business.

Research may include:

- Family tree development
- Ancestral and family-line research
- Historical record searches, including civil registration, census and other relevant sources
- Investigation of specific questions, research challenges or “brick walls”

Client Responsibilities

The client agrees to:

- Provide accurate and truthful information
- Supply relevant known details that may assist the research
- Tell The Origin Hunter about material corrections or updates
- Avoid providing unnecessary sensitive or highly private information about living relatives
- Understand that the quality and direction of research depend on the information and evidence available

Limitations of Research

- Research depends on the availability, accuracy and accessibility of historical records
- Record coverage varies by country, region and time period; some projects may fall outside the sources The Origin Hunter can effectively research
- Some records may be incomplete, restricted, unavailable online or unavailable to The Origin Hunter
- Findings, family relationships, breakthroughs and specific outcomes cannot be guaranteed

Research Platform & Access

Research may be conducted using online genealogy platforms including Ancestry.com and Findmypast. Where appropriate, a family tree may be created and maintained on such platforms. Clients may be invited to view their tree and research findings by guest access.

- Guest access may allow the client to view the family tree structure and associated information
- Access to original records or document images may depend on the platform's subscription requirements
- Clients may need their own subscription to view some records and documents directly

The Origin Hunter will provide summaries and explanations of findings in the agreed report or research material regardless of platform access. Trees created for the client will be kept private while under The Origin Hunter's control, and available privacy settings will be used for living individuals. Once access or control is transferred to the client, the client is responsible for later changes they make to privacy or sharing settings.

Fees & Payment

- Fees and the chosen research package are agreed before work begins
- Any additional paid research requires the client's approval in advance
- The Origin Hunter's own subscriptions to research services such as Ancestry or Findmypast are included in the agreed research fee where applicable; this does not provide the client with a personal subscription

Data Protection & Privacy

The Origin Hunter will collect and process personal information only where reasonably necessary to provide family history research and administer the commission.

Research may involve limited information about living individuals, such as names, dates or places of birth and family relationships. Such information will be handled with appropriate care and will not normally be made publicly accessible.

Where family trees are created using genealogy platforms such as Ancestry, available privacy settings will be used for living individuals and the tree will remain private while under The Origin Hunter's control.

Clients should avoid providing unnecessary sensitive or highly private information about living relatives.

The Origin Hunter does not sell personal information. Full details of how information is collected, used, stored and protected, and of data protection rights, are set out in The Origin Hunter Privacy Notice available on the website.

Cancellations & Refunds

- For contracts agreed at a distance (for example online or by email), statutory cancellation rights may apply, including a 14-day cancellation period where required by law
- If the client expressly asks for research to begin during a statutory cancellation period and later cancels, the client may be required to pay a proportionate amount for work already carried out
- Nothing in these Terms & Conditions limits the client's statutory consumer rights

Intellectual Property

- The Origin Hunter retains ownership of its original research notes, report wording and presentation until agreed payment has been received
- After payment, the client may use the completed research and report for personal and family-history purposes. Copyright or access rights in third-party records, images and platform content remain with their respective owners

Acceptance of Terms

Acceptance is recorded through the Client Information Form. Before research begins, the client will be asked to confirm that they have read and agree to these Terms & Conditions and have read the Privacy Notice.